

Groww with you

Simple when you're starting. Powerful when you're ready.

a. My take on the problem

"Design Groww for Gen Z" is easy to read as "make Groww look younger", with a brighter UI, streaks and memes. I think that solves the wrong problem. SEBI's 2025 investor survey found that 79% of Gen Z households surveyed were risk-averse, and that fear of losses, product complexity and weak trust were what kept them from investing. The few who do take big risks are getting hurt: 88.5% of individual F&O traders under 30 lost money in FY26, so that group needs protecting.

People already like Groww because it's simple. What bothers me is that the same app serves a ₹500 first-timer and an options scalper in almost the same way, and recent releases have mostly added trader tools like scalper mode, option Greeks and MTF. Beginners end up overwhelmed, stuck on five questions: Where do I start? What does this mean? What will it cost? Where is my money? Is what I saw online true?

So my take is that Gen Z needs Groww to grow with them, starting simple and showing more as they get comfortable.

b. In scope

A clickable prototype of about 20 screens for a student, intern or first-jobber aged 18 to 24 with ₹500 to ₹5,000 to invest. It covers six flows:

1. My Groww (experience-based onboarding and a Beginner Home)
2. Practice Mode
3. Money Lens
4. Money Tracker
5. Claim Check
6. Risk Check

All market data and transaction states are simulated.

c. Out of scope

The prototype doesn't rebuild Groww end to end or handle real orders, KYC or payments, and advanced trader tooling stays as it is. I'm also leaving out engagement mechanics like leaderboards and streaks on purpose, because they can optimize engagement around transaction frequency rather than financial understanding.

d. Solution and why

Groww with you adds complexity only as a user's confidence grows. The core journey has five steps: the app starts simple, you practise, you understand what happened, you invest for real, and you track your money.

My Groww keeps the start simple. Onboarding asks what brings you here and sets up a Beginner, Intermediate or Trader Home. Nothing is removed. Only the order of what you see first changes, and you can switch at any time.

Practice Mode is the centre of the experience. It gives you ₹1,00,000 of clearly labelled practice money with realistic orders, charges and P&L, so your first real "Buy" isn't the first time you see what happens after one. This is where a beginner builds confidence before any real money is at stake, and it doesn't award points.

Money Lens explains what you're looking at. Numbers like XIRR, average price and DP charges explain themselves using your own figures, and every order shows its true cost before you confirm.

Once you invest, Money Tracker and Trust Center follow every rupee the way a delivery app follows an order, with expected dates, delay alerts and support-case status. Stuck money and support loops were among the strongest recurring complaints in my research.

Claim Check and Risk Check extend this journey for the riskier moments. Claim Check lets you paste a influencer's claim and separates what can be verified from what is a prediction, without calling anyone wrong. Risk Check runs before F&O. It explains the product in plain language, shows a simulated loss, asks three questions and offers an optional daily loss limit. I'd rather add a little friction before the risk than restrict people after they've lost money.

Why I think this works: it goes after the barriers SEBI's survey found (fear of losses, complexity and trust), it protects the users most likely to get hurt, and it keeps the simplicity Groww is already known for. I wouldn't count time spent in the app as success. I'd track activation, SIP continuation, fewer "where's my money?" tickets, and how many users choose to move up to advanced mode, since that shows they need less hand-holding than when they started.